Poland

ULI POLAND CONFERENCE

MATRIX OF REAL ESTATE

15-16 April 2026 | Event Hall, Warsaw

15 April 2026

12:00 – 15:00

SITE TOURS - various locations

19:30 – 22:30

OPENING CONFERENCE DINNER - Event Hall at Fabryka Norblina, Warsaw (open to all registrants)

CYCLES, SHOCKS AND TECH WAVES: what next?

Opening Keynote

- **Andrew Baum**, Emeritus Professor, University of Oxford

16 April 2026 Event Hall at Fabryka Norblina, Warsaw

08:00 - 09:00

FAMILY OFFICE BREAKFAST in partnership with Masketan Multi-Family Office (by invitation only)

08:30

Registration and welcome coffee

09:00

Welcome

- **Marcin Juszczyk**, Chair of ULI Poland
- Conference host: **Marcin Żebrowski**, Urban Partners

09:15

GEOPOLITICAL OUTLOOK

Opening Keynote followed by a Fireside Chat

- **Mark F. Brzezinski**, former U.S. Ambassador to Poland (2021–2024)
- Interviewer: **Lejb Fogelman**, Senior Partner, Greenberg Traurig Warsaw Office

10:00

INVESTMENT PANEL: WILL 2026 BE A GROUNDHOG DAY IN THE CEE INVESTMENT MARKETS?

Presentation followed by a panel discussion

- **Simon Durkin**, CEO, ULI Europe
- **Thomas Kächele**, Director, Head of Germany & CEE, M&G Real Estate
- **Magda Uler-Kłeczek**, CIO, 7R
- **Nebil Şenman**, Co-Owner and Managing Partner, Griffin Capital Partners
- Moderator: **Søren Olsen**, Managing Director of Logicenters Poland at Urban Partners

10:55

THE BOARDROOM BLIND SPOT: WHEN CYBER THREATS TARGET TRUST AND DECISION-MAKING

Keynote presentation followed by a Fireside Chat

- **Sarah Armstrong-Smith**, Executive Director, Secure Horizons, former Chief of Security at Microsoft
- Interviewer: **Brett Hartle**, Head of CEE, WiredScore

11:25 Coffee break

11:55

ULI POLAND REPORT LAUNCH: URBAN DESTINATIONS PROJECTS IN POLAND

Presentation followed by Q&A

- **Maximilian Mendel**, ULI Poland Urban Living PC Co-Chair; Managing Partner, SPHERE Asset Management

12:10

ADAPTING CITIES FOR A RESILIENT FUTURE

Presentation **Cities That Compound: Resilience As Competitive Infrastructure** followed by a panel discussion

- **Ditte Lysgaard Vind**, Chief Science & Innovation Officer, BLOXHUB
- **Maciej Fijałkowski**, City Secretary, City of Warsaw
- **Katarzyna Gruszecka-Spychała**, former Deputy Mayor of Gdynia
- **Marta Sękulska-Wrońska**, CEO, WXCA
- **Aleksandra Smith-Kozlowska**, Director, Research, ULI Europe
- Moderator: **Marcin Żebrowski**, Urban Partners

13:05

HOW WILL DEMOGRAPHIC AND SOCIAL SHIFTS RESHAPE HOUSING SECTOR?

Presentation followed by a panel discussion

- **Adam Czerniak**, Deputy President, National Real Estate Stock
- **Renata McCabe-Kudła**, Country Manager, Grupo Lar
- **Konrad Wilczak**, Deputy Head of Poland, EBRD
- **Dagmara Kryskiewicz**, Co-founder, Agenox/Associate, MI – Multiple Impact
- Moderator: **Joanna Wojnarowska**, Partner, DWF Poland

14:00 Networking Lunch

15:00

THE ATOMIC QUESTION: ENERGY TRANSFORMATION AT A TURNING POINT

Presentation followed by a panel discussion

- **Paweł Olszynka**, Head ICT & Digital Market Analyst, PMR Market Experts
- **Paco González**, Founder & Partner, Core Tech Capital
- **Marcin Ciepliński**, Director of Strategy and Development, ORLEN Synthos Green Energy
- **Wojciech Wrochna**, Government Plenipotentiary for Strategic Energy Infrastructure; Secretary of State in the Ministry of Energy
- Moderator: **Dorota Wysokińska-Kuzdra**, Senior Partner, Colliers
- Moderator: **Piotr Staniszewski**, Pinsent Masons

15:55

THE REAL FOUNDATION - NATURE'S HIDDEN ROLE IN REAL ESTATE VALUE

Closing Keynote – Future Outlook

- **Kirsty Wilman**, Chair of the Investment Committee & Chief Operating Officer, Rebalance Earth

16:30 Wrap-up and close of the conference

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ANDREW BAUM

Emeritus Professor, University of Oxford, Saïd Business School

Andrew is Emeritus Professor of Practice at the Saïd Business School, University of Oxford, where until 2021 he led the Future of Real Estate Initiative. He is Chairman of Newcore Capital Management, a real estate fund manager focussed on sustainable investment in social infrastructure, and advisor to several property organisations. He holds BSc, MPhil and PhD degrees from the University of Reading, and is a graduate of the London Business School investment management programme, a chartered surveyor and a qualified member of the CFA institute (ASIP). He has held senior positions with Grosvenor, Nuveen, CBRE Global Investors and others. Baum's PropTech 3.0: The Future of Real Estate was the most downloaded Saïd Business School report in 2017.In 2021 he was awarded an honorary doctorate by the University College of Estate Management. He is the author or co-author of six real estate finance textbooks with combined sales of over 75,000. He is a qualified member of the RICS and the CFA Institute. He is founder and former president of the Reading Real Estate Foundation, an educational charity established to support real estate education. He was elected Academic Fellow of the Urban Land Institute in 2001, the first such election outside the USA, and Honorary Fellow of the Society of Property Researchers in 2002.

MARK F. BRZEZINSKI

President and CEO, Brzezinski Global Strategies / former Ambassador

Ambassador (ret.) Mark Brzezinski has a distinguished career in public service and the private sector. He served as U.S. Ambassador to Poland (2021–2024), a period marked by Polish democratic renewal and the establishment of the first permanent U.S. military installation. During his tenure, Mark spearheaded a $30 billion deal for American firms to build Poland's first civil nuclear power plant. For his service, he was awarded the Commander's Cross of the Order of Merit by the President of Poland.

As U.S. Ambassador to Sweden (2011–2015), facilitated major trade investments, including Volvo's $1 billion U.S. factory. Arranged the 2013 U.S.-Nordic summit during the first U.S. Presidential visit to Stockholm, receiving the rare Royal Order of the Polar Star.

In 2015, served as the first Executive Director of the White House's Arctic Executive Steering Committee, driving historic engagement and the inaugural Arctic Science Ministerial. Served on the National Security Council (1999–2001) as Director for Russia, Eurasia, and the Balkans.

Private sector roles include Managing Director at Makena Capital Management and partner at McGuireWoods LLP. A former Fulbright Scholar, holds a BA from Dartmouth, a JD from the University of Virginia, and a Doctorate in Political Science from Oxford.

Mark has published articles in major international outlets and has been interviewed by various leading news networks. Currently serves as President and CEO of Brzezinski Global Strategies.

LEJB FOGELMAN

Senior Partner, Greenberg Traurig Warsaw Office

With over 40 years of professional experience. His practice focuses on complex, often multi-billion dollar domestic and international transactions, including M&A, privatizations, company reorganizations, joint ventures, transaction financing and public offerings of shares. Widely regarded as Poland's foremost M&A lawyer, his leading position is reflected in international and national rankings, such as Chambers Global, Chambers Europe, Legal 500, and IFLR1000, in which he regularly occupies the highest positions. He has also received prestigious industry titles and awards, including the Lawyer of the 30 Years award, confirming his long-term impact on the development of the legal services market in Poland.

MARCIN JUSZCZYK

Managing Partner, Capital Park / Chair of ULI Poland

Serving as Chairman of the Urban Land Institute in Poland and Vice President of Capital Park Group, brings over 20 years of real estate experience. Oversees strategic business development, M&A, joint ventures, and finance. Has executed 100+ property transactions, secured €700m+ in bank financing, and raised €100m+ on the Polish capital market. Acts as a local partner to leading private equity funds like Patron Capital and Madison International. Notably developed Warsaw's Norblin Factory, winner of the 2022 ULI Global Award for Excellence. An active member of PINK and the REIT Poland Association, specializing in sustainable urban development, mixed-use, and brownfield regeneration.

MARCIN ŻEBROWSKI

Research, Ecosystem, Knowledge Lead, Urban Partners

Shapes urban partnerships and strategic positioning across Europe, coordinating collaborations with C40, Ramboll, Arup, and BLOXHUB. Responsibilities include steering knowledge production, editorial strategy, and managing flagship publications like The Copenhagen Way, a joint study on urban transformation. Additionally, serves as founder and host of Urbcast, a leading bilingual podcast on architecture and urbanism with 250+ episodes reaching 130+ countries. Leveraging a background in business development—previously supporting global bids at Henning Larsen—expertise spans strategic communication and project positioning. Also an experienced event moderator, leading conferences and engaging audiences of 1,000+ on complex urban topics.

SARAH ARMSTRONG-SMITH

Executive Director, Secure Horizons

One of the industry's most influential cybersecurity leaders, bringing three decades of front-line experience to help organisations build resilience against digital disruptions and global crises. Past roles include Chief Security Advisor at Microsoft and Group Head of Crisis Management at The London Stock Exchange. She authored 'Effective Crisis Management' and the Amazon best-seller 'Understand the Cyber Attacker Mindset', exploring the psychology of cyber warfare. As a global advocate and keynote speaker, she frequently shares market-leading insights at major events and media outlets, including NATO, the World Energy Council, and Sky News. Her engaging style is trusted globally by Fortune 500 companies and government agencies.

BRETT HARTLE

Head of Business Development CEE, WiredScore

Based in Warsaw, he oversees global certifications for digital connectivity and smart building technology across Central and Eastern Europe. By implementing WiredScore and SmartScore standards, he partners with investors and developers to maximize asset value and long-term competitiveness.

Throughout a 15-year career with Skanska, WeWork, and within the PropTech sector, he has managed complex developments across the US, Nordics, and CEE. Holding a degree in Construction Management from the University of Washington, he brings a unique global perspective on integrating physical construction with technology to drive commercial success in modern real estate.

MAXIMILIAN MENDEL

Managing Partner, SPHERE Asset Management

Co-founded SPHERE Asset Management to drive collaboration in the Polish living sector and beyond. Previously served as Managing Director of ZEITGEIST Asset Management, overseeing the Polish branch and related SPVs. Prior roles include Senior Director and Head of Living Investment at JLL, and Partner at REAS | Residential Advisors. Brings 20 years of real estate experience spanning investor relations, transactions, asset management, property development, operations, and advisory. Holds a master's in urban planning from TU Dortmund and a PhD from the Polish Academy of Sciences. MRICS member and co-chair of the ULI Urban Living Product Council in Poland.

SIMON DURKIN

CEO, ULI Europe, ULI Europe

Appointed in 2026, he brings over 20 years of experience across real estate, applied research, and global capital markets. Previously, he was Global Head of Real Estate Research and Strategy at BlackRock, leading the global research agenda and serving on the Global Investment Committee.

Before BlackRock, he held senior leadership roles at BNP Paribas and DWS, and began his career in data and index development at IPD and Property & Portfolio Research. He now focuses on sharpening the organization's value proposition and reinforcing its role as a trusted platform for convening leaders, sharing knowledge, and driving responsible value creation across Europe's built environment.

THOMAS KÄCHELE

Director, Head of Germany and CEE, M&G Real Estate

Thomas opened the German branch of M&G in 2013. Since then, he's responsible for Acquisition and Asset Management for Germany and CEE, mainly Poland. Before he took over CEE, Thomas was responsible for the Netherlands and the Nordics. Working for several M&G funds, the focus is not only on Residential Assets but all Asset Classes. Before joining M&G, Thomas was responsible for the Asset Management within ING Real Estate in Germany and thereafter he worked for a family office in several functions to oversee their real estate activities and project developments. Thomas started his career in the construction business as a civil engineer, managing several big turn key projects, mainly logistics warehouses and office properties.

MAGDALENA ULER-KŁECZEK

Chief Investment Officer, 7R

Serves as a Board Member and leads the Capital Markets team, bringing over 12 years of commercial real estate experience. She drives strategic growth, secures equity financing for logistics developments, manages investor relations, and oversees asset disposals.

Since April 2023, she has led approximately €100 million in asset disposals and secured equity partners for projects across Poland and Czechia totaling over €100 million.

Previously, she spent 11 years at JLL and Colliers, advising on logistics and office sector transactions exceeding €2.5 billion. She was recently named the 2024 CEEQA Rising Star Industry Professional.

NEBIL ŞENMAN

Co-Owner and Managing Partner, Griffin Capital Partners

Before joining Griffin in 2014, he held senior roles at Oaktree's private equity and real estate funds, overseeing European investments worth several billion euros focusing on Germany and Poland.

Prior to Oaktree, he spent eight years at Ernst & Young Real Estate (formerly Arthur Andersen) in various managerial real estate and corporate finance advisory roles.

A Turkish-German citizen, he holds an MBA and a Master's in Civil Engineering, having studied in Berlin, Paris, and London. He also holds a post-graduate diploma in real estate management and is a Chartered Member of the Royal Institution of Chartered Surveyors (MRICS).

SØREN OLSEN

Managing Director of Logicenters Poland, Urban Partners

Søren established Urban Partners' office in Poland in 2021 and leads Urban Partners' logistics business development activities in Poland, with focus on investment sourcing, asset mgmt., and key relationships with co-investors and large tenants. He has over 20 years' experience in the Polish market having previously held senior mgmt. positions in Bank Austria Creditanstalt, HVB Group, Aberdeen as well as 10 years with Cushman & Wakefield where he was a Partner and Head of Capital Markets. Søren is renowned and highly respected industry expert with substantial international business network, keynote speaker, panelist, conference moderator, and mentor. He holds an MBA from University of Westminster and sits on the Board of ULI Poland.

DITTE LYSGAARD VIND

Chief Innovation & Science Officer, BLOXHUB

Ditte is Co-lead & Chief Innovation and Science Officer at BLOXHUB a Nordic hub for sustainable urbanisation, and author of A Changemakers Guide to the Future (Lendager '18) & Danish Design Heritage & Global Sustainability (Routledge '24).

MACIEJ FIJAŁKOWSKI

City Secretary, City of Warsaw

Appointed Secretary of the City of Warsaw in 2024, following a tenure at City Hall since 2007. He previously headed the European Funds and Development Policy Department, managing EU funding and strategic municipal investments for over a decade. Currently oversees the European Funds, Investment Policy, and Legal departments. His responsibilities span investment policy coordination, public transit, and regional cooperation. Notably, he manages a municipal budget exceeding €4 billion for the 2026–2030 period.

He played a key role in the "#Warszawa2030" and metropolitan area 2040 development strategies, bringing extensive expertise in urban economic development, external funding, and cross-sector partnerships.

KATARZYNA GRUSZECKA-SPYCHAŁA

University of Gdańsk

A qualified legal advisor specializing in urban governance and waterfront transformation, she served a decade as Deputy Mayor of Gdynia, overseeing spatial planning, entrepreneurship, and corporate governance. She later served as Vice-President of the Port of Gdynia, shaping the strategic direction of a key Polish seaport.

Currently serving on the Polish Academy of Sciences' Task Force on Cities and the University of Gdańsk Council, her focus is the city-water interface and managing complex waterfront assets. She also holds a degree in Italian studies, drawing strategic inspiration from the historic rise of Italian city-states to inform modern urban development.

MARTA SĘKULSKA-WROŃSKA

CEO, WXCA

Former President of the Warsaw Branch of the Association of Polish Architects (2019-2023) and member of the SARP Competition Judges College. Specializing in complex public architecture, she has led award-winning projects including the Polish Pavilion at Expo 2020 and the Warsaw Citadel museum complex.

A two-time Mies van der Rohe Award nominee for the Palmiry Memorial Museum and Chęciny Geological Education Center, she deeply integrates natural and social contexts into her designs. Currently, she is creating a vision for the 60-hectare F.S.O. Park district and reconstructing the Saxon and Brühl Palaces at Piłsudski Square. She is a frequent industry speaker and graduate of the Warsaw University of Technology.

ALEKSANDRA SMITH-KOZLOWSKA

Director, Research, ULI Europe

Aleksandra is a director in Urban Land Institute's research team, and she specialises in sustainable built environment. Her role is to advance the C Change programme in Europe, supporting the real estate community to speed up the decarbonisation process and scale up initiatives. She is also working with the Randall Lewis Center for Sustainability at ULI's HQ in the United States, focusing on the business case for green buildings by tying carbon reductions to increased asset value.

ADAM CZERNIAK

Vice President, Krajowy Zasób Nieruchomości (National Real Estate Stock)

An associate professor at the SGH Warsaw School of Economics and head of the Institutional and Political Economy Unit. From 2013 to 2024, helped develop the Polityka Insight center for policy analysis, serving as chief economist and research director.

Previously worked as a banking economist and collaborated with the World Bank and the FOR Foundation. A former Ronald Coase Institute fellow, authored dozens of publications on housing studies, comparative capitalism, and political economy. Currently serves as the Polish representative to the European Master in Official Statistics Board.

RENATA MCCABE-KUDŁA

Country Manager, Grupo Lar Polska

Brought up in multicultural environment Living in Poland since 1995 Studied at Warsaw School of Economics ACCA certified Working in real estate since 23 years, first in Bouygues Immobilier, followed by 20 years in Grupo Lar Poland, initially as Finance Director, and as Country Manager since 3 years.

KONRAD WILCZAK

Associate Director / Senior Banker, EBRD - European Bank Reconstruction & Development

Serves as Deputy Head of Poland at the EBRD's Warsaw office. With over 15 years of corporate finance experience at the bank, he drives business development and project delivery, having originated and structured over EUR 2 billion in signed corporate sector investments.

Previously, he focused on capital market transactions as an Investment Associate at BZ WBK (Santander). His earlier career at EY involved advisory and financial modelling for infrastructure projects, public-private partnerships, and restructurings. He is a CFA charterholder.

DAGMARA KRYSKIEWICZ

Co-founder, Agenox/Associate, MI – Multiple Impact

An expert in regulatory compliance and European financial markets, combining legal expertise with a focus on longevity and the senior living sector. As co-founder of Agenox, integrates preventive healthcare, early diagnostics, and evidence-based anti-ageing strategies to promote high-quality longevity.

As an Associate at MI – Multiple Impact, supports the development of next-generation housing models for adults aged 60+ across the Benelux and CEE regions, creating active, purpose-driven communities. Additionally, as a member of the Senior Housing and Healthcare Association (SHHA), actively shapes healthy ageing concepts that blend health, design, and community in wellness real estate.

JOANNA WOJNAROWSKA

Senior Partner, Global Deputy Head of Real Estate, DWF Poland Jamka

With nearly 30 years at top international firms, she advises on high-profile real estate and construction projects across major asset classes. Expertise spans acquisitions, disposals, forward funding, and complex asset commercialisation. Recommended in Legal 500 and Chambers Europe, she was shortlisted for the 2025 Inspiring Women in Property Awards and recognized by My Company Polska as one of the 15 most influential women lawyers in business. Her DWF Poland Real Estate team also won Local Law Firm of the Year at the CEE Investment Awards. She serves as a Global Governing Trustee at ULI and a ULI Poland Executive Committee member, driving thought leadership and cross-sector collaboration to shape the future of cities.

PAWEŁ OLSZYNKA

Head ICT & Digital Market Analyst,PMR by Hume's | COO, PMR

With over 20 years of experience managing complex research projects and ICT market analyses across Poland and Central Europe, specializes in quantifying technological trends, developing forecasts, and building data-driven strategies to guide digital transformation.

As COO at PMR, leads a team of ICT analysts delivering strategic market insights on cloud computing, data centers, AI, cybersecurity, and telecommunications. An active industry expert, speaker, and moderator, frequently supporting clients in making informed business decisions. Graduated from the Krakow University of Economics and studied as a scholarship recipient at Grand Valley State University (Michigan, USA).

PACO GONZÁLEZ

Founder & Partner, Core Tech Capital

Founder & CEO of Core Tech Capital, a digital infrastructure investment firm operating platforms like Quetta Data Centers—currently building facilities in Madrid and Barcelona—and cartagon.ai, a sovereign European NeoCloud. The firm is also developing a nuclear-backed platform in France.

He previously founded Cartagon Cloud and served as President of EuroCloud Spain and EuroCloud Europe from 2014 to 2017. Also active in academia, he has lectured at prominent digital business schools including MIT Professional, ISDI, and The Valley.

MARCIN CIEPLIŃSKI

Director of Strategy & Development, ORLEN Synthos Green Energy

Active in the energy sector since 2004, with extensive experience at Polskie Sieci Elektroenergetyczne S.A. and PGE Polska Grupa Energetyczna S.A. Since 2007, he has played a vital role in implementing nuclear power in Poland, serving as Director of the Nuclear Energy Department at PGE S.A. starting in 2009.

In 2019, he became Director of the Program Coordination Office at PGE EJ 1 (now Polskie Elektrownie Jądrowe) before joining ORLEN Synthos Green Energy in 2022. He is a graduate of the Faculty of Law and Administration at the University of Warsaw.

WOJCIECH WROCHNA

Secretary of State, Ministry of Energy

Serving as Government Plenipotentiary for Strategic Energy Infrastructure, he is a legal expert specializing in EU, competition, and energy law. For nearly 15 years, he has advised on generation investments including renewables, nuclear, and hydrogen. He provides legal support for Poland's strategic energy, gas, and grid initiatives, having contributed to most of the country's key critical infrastructure projects.

Educated at the University of Silesia, Robert Schuman University, and holding an LL.M. from Luxembourg's International University Institute, his background spans EU institutions and government agencies. He is also an academic lecturer and published author on energy law.

DOROTA WYSOKIŃSKA-KUZDRA

Senior Partner, Colliers Poland

Joined Colliers in 2018 to lead Corporate Finance and Living Services for CEE, driving financial advisory (debt/mezzanine financing, capital raising, M&A) and living sector operations. Under this direction, the firm has participated in all major living and equity transactions across Poland and the CEE region.

Previously spent 11 years as Senior Partner at Griffin Real Estate, overseeing investments and Poland's first mezzanine fund. As CEO of Griffin Premium RE, successfully launched the first REIT on the Warsaw Stock Exchange. Earlier, held director roles in real estate investment banking for HypoVereinsbank/UniCredit Group for over a decade. Currently serves as a Global Governing Trustee for the Urban Land Institute.

PIOTR STANISZEWSKI

Pinsent Masons

A leading expert in non-contentious construction and development in Poland, recognized for industry leadership and ESG legal thought leadership. Focusing on real estate, corporate, and commercial law, he advises domestic and international investors on property development across data center, retail, office, logistics, and residential sectors.

His expertise covers construction, planning, permitting, and contract negotiation and enforcement. He also manages real estate transactions and lease projects for commercial and industrial developments, and acts for international financial institutions in financing real estate investments.

KIRSTY WILMAN

Chair of the Investment Committee & Chief Operating Officer, Rebalance Earth

Brings over 20 years' experience in private markets operations, finance, governance, and audit, specializing in institutional real asset strategies. Previously spent over 14 years at Federated Hermes in senior roles, including Real Estate COO and Private Markets Head of Operations, building institutional fund platforms and overseeing complex fund structures.

A Fellow of the ICAEW holding the Investment Management Certificate, she provides deep expertise in assurance, valuation oversight, and operational risk management. She also serves as a Non-Executive Director of FTSE 250-listed Tritax Big Box REIT plc, sitting on its Audit and Management Engagement Committees.

full bios at poland.uli.org